

Bronte Harbour Classic 5K — Monthly Team Meeting

Meeting Minutes — March 4, 2026

Date: Wednesday, March 4, 2026

Time: ~1:30 PM (in-person)

Location: [In-person — Oakville/Burlington area]

Duration: Approximately 1 hour 34 minutes

Attendees:

- Greg Kowalczyk — Co-Race Director (TapeGeeks / GearTOP)
- Jono Spies
- Myles Cameron
- Patricia (TapeGeeks)
- Adriana
- Yasmine (hello@startwithyaz.com)

Apologies:

- Charles J. Sathmary — Co-Race Director (unavailable)
- Ursula (noted as absent during shirt/apparel discussion)

Race Status: 109 days to race day (June 21, 2026)

Current Registrations: ~91 participants | Target: 800

1. Registration & Fundraising

- Registration currently sitting at approximately 91 participants against a target of 800.
- The team acknowledged that April and May will require a significant marketing push to drive registrations.
- Pricing remains in the February 1 – March 31 tier; urgency increases after March 31 when pricing steps up.
- No specific fundraising updates were discussed beyond the Oakville Dads charity alignment.

2. Sponsorships & Partnerships

Confirmed Sponsors

- **CIBC** — Confirmed founding sponsor (\$5,000). Payment not yet received. Booth confirmed.
- **ON Running** — Confirmed as Official Shoe Sponsor. Currently at 8 pairs of shoes; team pushing for 10–12 pairs as race prizes.
- **Radix / Natrilyte** — Confirmed as Official Hydration/Water Station Sponsor. Will provide electrolyte product at finish line. Booth to be set up at the expo. Note: Radix and Natrilyte are presented as the same sponsorship.

- **Be Active (Physio)** — Confirmed sponsor; will sponsor all race prizes and have a booth at the expo.

Pending / In Negotiation

Cedar Planters (Title Sponsor — Priority)

- Cedar Planters relocated from Spears Avenue to the Great Lakes area (new warehouse on Greyhouse).
- Greg had an existing relationship with them and messaged their WhatsApp. It then emerged that **Liz (Liz Carino) is both a volunteer committee member for BHC and works at Cedar Planters** — this was a surprise to the group.
- Patricia reached out to Liz approximately 2 days before the meeting; Liz responded that she was too busy and has not yet engaged further.
- Cedar Planters was brought to attention as a potential title sponsor by Kayla from the Bronte BIA.
- **Situation to navigate:** Liz's dual role as committee member and Cedar Planters employee creates a potential conflict of interest. The team needs to determine how to approach this sensitively — whether Liz is the right point of contact or whether a separate direct approach is needed.
- Status: **Pending — follow-up required immediately.**

Rockstar Real Estate Brokerage

- Greg has a long-standing personal relationship with the owners.
- Approached as title sponsor but they declined due to current economic conditions ("times are tough").
- However, they agreed to support the event through advertising and promotion.
- They will provide **a table/booth at their April 25 real estate conference** at the Airport Road Convention Centre — approximately 1,000 attendees, all local investors, running from 8 AM to 2 PM with networking breaks.
- They have a **podcast**: Greg and Charles are booked to record an episode about the race (how it was conceived, marketing, community element). Recording date TBD.
- Will advertise in their newsletter.
- Status: **Confirmed as promotional partner; booth/presence at April 25 event confirmed.**

Tim Hortons

- Discussed as a vendor/coffee truck presence (not supplying free coffee to all participants — operating as a vendor).
- No confirmation yet. Follow-up required.

Nickelbrook Brewery

- Being pursued for beer garden sponsorship/operation.
- Status: **Not confirmed. Follow-up required.**

Lululemon (Burlington location)

- The owner of the Burlington Lululemon location was identified as a potential announcer for the event, and was previously an announcer for Oakville events.
- By the time her contact was obtained, a Toronto-based announcer had already been committed.
- Lululemon Burlington still being considered as a sponsor or booth participant.
- **Lululemon Toronto contact** was also mentioned in the context of running influencer outreach (approached via Instagram DM).

Red Bull

- Red Bull expressed interest in bringing their branded truck with DJ setup to the event.
- They indicated they can "come with anything" and are interested.
- The team noted they have their own music programming (bands), but Red Bull as a brand presence would add energy.
- Status: **Pending sponsor commitment.** Documented internally as "Red Bull — pending sponsor."

Primal (Fitness Studio)

- Discussed as a potential vendor booth participant and sponsor.
- The group discussed exclusivity: exclusivity in a category can only be offered if a partner commits for 3 years in a row.
- Action: Reach out to Primal to offer vendor booth + swag bag contribution opportunity.

Peach Coffee / Colombia Coffee

- Discussed as potential in-store poster placement partners and possible small sponsors (\$250 level).
- Approach: ask them to put a poster in store and offer a 25% discount promotion to their customers; if they decline, approach Colombia Coffee (neighbouring location).

3. Vendor Expo & Logistics

Layout & Booth Count

- Current vendor map has approximately 68–70 vendor spaces (reduced from an earlier version with 160 booths — the 160 count was impractical; 60–70 is the working plan).
- Vendor booth pricing confirmed:
- **\$250** — Booth space at the expo
- **\$250 + \$100 additional** = \$350 total for booth + swag bag item contribution
- **\$230** — Swag bag contribution only (no booth)
- Corner booth premium pricing: to be determined.
- Booth locations for confirmed partners: Be Active, CIBC, Radix/Natrilyte, Oakville Dads, BIA, Town of Oakville, Saint John Ambulance — all to be confirmed and assigned numbers on the map.
- Vendor map to be finalized, then submitted to the Town of Oakville for approval.
- Once finalized, booths will be numbered and vendor assignments fixed.

Vendor Application

- The vendor application was reviewed briefly at the meeting — it was considered largely complete.
- Action: Complete any outstanding sections and get it live.
- Action: Build a working spreadsheet of committed vendors.

Porta-Potties

- **Yasmine has obtained a quote.** Quantity discussed: 7–8 units.
- Industry ratio: approximately 1 unit per 75–100 attendees. The park also has existing washroom facilities.
- Placement: top-left area of the site map, away from the start line and close to the parking area.
- Action: Finalize booking now — Yasmine to confirm.

Food Trucks

- Food trucks are positioned along the main path in the current layout and are considered well-placed.
- The area near the food trucks needs to be kept clear for truck arrival/setup (vehicles driving in).
- Note: Food trucks are different from vendor booths; both are being managed.

Equipment & Supplies

- Burlington Sound of Music organizers (Greg was in contact) have offered to **lend tents, barriers, and tables**. Terms (exchange for what) still to be worked out.
- Action: Reach out to Sound of Music organizers to confirm what equipment is available and on what basis.

Bronte Legion

- The Bronte Legion has a parking lot that may be available for vendor parking or exhibiting.
- Action: Confirm parking lot access with the Legion.

Vendor Arrival & Staggering

- Setup crew on-site from 4–5 AM.
- Roads close at 7 AM.
- Vendor arrival times to be staggered to prevent congestion at the entrance.
- Expo runs 8 AM to 3 PM.

Swim Club / Summer Camps

- Discussed as potential vendor/booth participants.
- Action: Check with local swim club; reach out to summer camps and youth programs.

Vendor with Breathing / Yoga

- "Manjit" (name from transcript) — associated with a breathing/yoga studio — was identified as a potential vendor.
- "Nancy" (from Ace) was suggested as someone who could help promote vendor opportunities.

4. Route & Traffic Control

Two Route Options Under Review

- A traffic control plan and map were submitted to the Town of Oakville. The submission came after Greg had reached a point of needing a backup contact, and the traffic control company felt pressure and submitted.

- **Route Option 1 (preferred):** The original route discussed — described as the more appealing option. The route goes along the waterfront and loops back. Specific details reference going "around the parking lot and back," avoiding John Street, and providing a smoother traffic management scenario.
- **Route Option 2 (alternative):** A different routing that the group considered but found less appealing for traffic flow.
- Final route direction (clockwise vs. counterclockwise) pending Town of Oakville approval.
- Both routes are under review with the Town. Changes from the town are expected.

Apartment Building Exits

- Along the race route, **every single apartment building exit must be staffed** with a volunteer in a high-visibility vest to prevent residents from driving out during the race.
- The team needs to count the exact number of apartment exits along the route to determine volunteer requirements.
- Traffic control barricades are specified in the plan for each apartment exit.

Start/Finish Line

- Start line location referenced on the map. Timing equipment placement to be confirmed once route is approved.
- Chip timing confirmed for the 5K race.

5. Marketing & Media

BIA Newsletter

- Greg met with **Kayla from the Bronte BIA** — a productive meeting. Kayla is fully supportive of the race and committed to spreading the word.
- Greg already submitted a piece for the BIA newsletter; it **will be published in the newsletter going out at the beginning of March** (already submitted as of meeting date).
- Kayla provided media contacts including: **Oakville News, Inside Halton, TV Halton.**
- The BIA has a vendor network of approximately 70 vendors for their marketplace — they will reach out to their vendor list on behalf of BHC.
- Kayla also has contacts at the **Kerr Street business association** — to be leveraged for additional media outreach.

Media Contacts

- Additional media contact: A photographer for the **Burlington News** was met in person during a Sunday run and given the race contact details.
- Full media list assembled: TV Halton, Inside Halton, Oakville News, Burlington News.
- Action: Prepare a formal media release with a photograph and distribute to all media contacts.

Poster Campaign

- A poster with QR code needs to be printed (updated version with QR code required — current version may not have it).
- Plan: Print 50+ posters; divide among 5 team members (10 posters each) to distribute this coming **Saturday and Sunday** at:
 - Local coffee shops (Peach Coffee, Colombia Coffee)
 - Local businesses
 - BIA gazebo area (one poster already discussed for the BIA-owned gazebo)
 - The distribution effort can be documented on social media.
- Action: Finalize poster design with QR code; print 50+ copies; coordinate distribution weekend.

Social Media Giveaway

- Discussed as a mechanism to grow followers and engagement quickly.
- Idea: A "follow us and tag" style giveaway.
- Leverage existing sponsors' and committed partners' social media channels to amplify.
- Action: Design and launch a giveaway campaign.

Running Influencers & Community Outreach

- Strategy: Find running coaches and influencers via Instagram, follow and DM them.
- Specific contacts to pursue:
 - **Runner's Den** — Greg is about to reach out.
 - **Lululemon Toronto** — already connected via Instagram DM approach.
 - **Lucas at Running Room** — Charles's contact; noted as someone who can connect to other running communities. To be followed up.
- Action: Systematically reach out to running influencers and coaches.

Rockstar Real Estate — April 25 Conference

- At the April 25 Airport Road Convention Centre conference (~1,000 local attendees), BHC will have a **table/booth presence**.
- Greg to coordinate logistics for this.
- Podcast episode with Charles and Greg to be recorded (timing TBD).

"Your Life Your Terms" Podcast

- Greg and Charles are booked for an episode on the Rockstar Real Estate podcast ("Your Life Your Terms").
- Content will cover the race concept, marketing, and community story.
- Content can be repurposed across BHC's own channels.

6. Design & Merchandise

Medals

- Meeting with **Kelly, Greg Pace, and Charles** is planned (this Sunday) to discuss the **three-race series medal design**:
- Moon in June (Burlington)
- Bronte Harbour Classic (Oakville)
- Canada Day (location TBD)
- Concept: **Interlocking medals** — each individual race medal can be combined/interlocked with the others to form one larger piece when a participant completes all three races.
- Participants completing all three races would receive a **fourth special medal** (bonus for the series).
- Price reduction for series participants also discussed.
- Medal type: design will differ depending on whether interlocking (cast) vs. stamped metal — this affects the design brief.
- Note: It's unclear whether Moon in June or Canada Day race have already ordered/designed their medals. This needs to be confirmed before BHC commits to a shared design direction.
- A local designer may be engaged for the medal design.

T-Shirts

- Shirt supplier: **Brent from Global Citizen** — Greg met with Brent on the day of the meeting.
- T-shirt timeline: 6–8 weeks before race day (so approximately mid-April at the latest for design finalization).
- Design concept: Light-colored shirt (light blue discussed); sponsor logos on the back; race branding on front.
- Printing spec: **Single-color print** or **color shirt + up to 3 colors** (per Brent's recommendation). If using a colored shirt, a base layer may be needed under additional colors.
- Style debate: Some team members noted that technical running shirts (dry-fit) are often not worn after the race. Preference expressed for a more **casual/lifestyle shirt** (e.g., cotton/poly blend) that people will actually wear post-race.
- Action: Finalize design direction; confirm specs with Brent; place order approximately 6–8 weeks out from race day.
- Volunteer shirts: Separate design for volunteers, potentially with a distinct logo treatment. High-vis vests for on-course volunteers (see Section 8).

7. Event Layout & Setup

A site map was reviewed during the meeting. Key layout decisions discussed:

- **Kids Zone:** Moved to the bottom-right corner, near the **water feature** in the park, so children can access the water and the kids zone together. Note: the kids zone and water feature may need to be cordoned off from each other for safety.
- **Beer Garden:** Originally near the kids zone; now being repositioned. Two proposals discussed:
 - Place beer garden near the music stage (bottom-left corner) — keeps the "adults area" together.
 - Place beer garden in the first few rows of vendor space near the stage — this risks bisecting foot traffic flow and may disadvantage vendors on the other side.
 - Group preference leaned toward beer garden adjacent to the music stage in a dedicated corner area, similar to how other festivals manage it.
- **Music Stage:** Bottom-left corner of the site. Power confirmed available at the stage location.
- **Food Trucks:** Current placement considered good — positioned along the main path. The food truck entry/exit lane must be kept clear.
- **Porta-Potties:** Top-left area, near the parking, away from the start line.
- **Jumping Castle / Inflatable:** Need to identify a flat area for setup.
- **Booth Numbering:** Once layout is finalized, all booths to be numbered and vendor assignments locked in.
- **Seating:** Grass seating area near the performance stage to be identified.

8. Volunteers & Operations

Oakville Dads

- **Oakville Dads confirmed** as the primary volunteer organization — expected to supply **60+ volunteers**.
- Greg had a recent meeting with Oakville Dads.
- Monthly coordination meetings between BHC team and Oakville Dads recommended going forward.
- Oakville Dads booth confirmed at the expo.

Shift Times

- **4–5 AM:** Setup crew and team on-site
- **7 AM:** Roads close; barricades go up
- **8 AM:** Race / expo opens
- **3 PM:** Expo closes

High-Visibility Vests

- All on-course volunteers (particularly at apartment building exits) need **high-vis vests**.
- Options: Purchase branded vests, or borrow from other races (Greg Pace / Moon in June inventory was mentioned as a possible source).

- Traffic control company likely supplies their own vests/barricades for their staff; BHC still needs vests for the race's own volunteers.
- Action: Determine whether vests need to be procured or can be borrowed; count required quantity based on apartment exit count.

Volunteer Shirts

- Volunteers will have their own designated shirts/vest with branding (distinct from race participant shirts).

9. Music & Entertainment

Live Bands

- Plan: **2–3 local bands**, each playing 2-hour sets, from 10 AM to 3 PM.
- One band suggested may be more of a "nighttime" style — suitability for a daytime family festival to be considered.
- Jono noted he has contacts for bands.
- Burlington Sound of Music organizers also mentioned as a source for musician contacts.
- Action: Jono to finalize band lineup.

Red Bull Truck

- Red Bull has expressed interest in bringing their branded truck with a DJ setup.
- If Red Bull comes, they would handle their own music/DJ element, which the team would need to coordinate with the band schedule (so they don't compete).
- Red Bull's participation is contingent on confirming them as a sponsor.
- Action: Finalize Red Bull sponsor commitment before confirming truck.

Announcer

- A Toronto-based announcer has already been committed: available 6:30 AM – 3 PM (approximately 8 hours).
- The Lululemon Burlington owner was identified as someone with announcing experience but was connected too late to be engaged for this role.
- Action: Confirm announcer details and contract.

10. Permits & Operations

Race Insurance

- **\$5M CGL (Commercial General Liability) race insurance** — application not yet completed.
- This is a critical outstanding item. The insurance application needs to be filled out and submitted.
- Action: Complete and submit race insurance application. **Priority.**

Town of Oakville

- Traffic control plan submitted to the Town. Changes and feedback from the Town are expected.
- Once the revised plan (incorporating Town feedback) is finalized, it will be resubmitted for approval.
- The vendor site map also needs to be submitted to the Town for approval.
- Action: Monitor Town of Oakville review; address any requested changes promptly.

Resident Notifications

- Residents in apartments and townhouses along the race route need to be notified of road closures.
- Method: Deliver notices **by hand** to building managers and townhouses.
- Action: Prepare resident notification letters; coordinate hand delivery.

11. Meeting Cadence

- **Two weeks from now:** Zoom call — quick progress update (shorter and more focused than in-person meetings).
- **Monthly:** Continue in-person team meetings.
- The team confirmed this hybrid cadence (monthly in-person + bi-weekly Zoom) going forward.

Action Items

#ActionOwnerDeadline1Complete and submit race insurance (\$5M CGL) applicationGreg**ASAP — Priority**2Follow up with Cedar Planters re: title sponsorship (navigate Liz's dual role carefully)Greg / PatriciaThis week3Finalize Radix/Natrilyte hydration station sponsorship details and booth assignmentGreg**ASAP**4Follow up with Rockstar Real Estate re: April 25 conference table logisticsGreg**ASAP**5Coordinate with Rockstar Real Estate to book podcast episode recording (Charles + Greg)GregThis week6Book Tim Hortons (vendor/coffee truck)Greg**ASAP**7Reach out to Nickelbrook re: beer gardenGreg**ASAP**8Reach out to Primal re: vendor booth + swag bag contributionTeamThis week9Finalize Red Bull sponsor commitment; then confirm truckGreg**ASAP**10Confirm Lululemon Burlington as sponsor/booth (even if not announcer)Greg**ASAP**11Finalize and publish vendor application (complete any outstanding sections)Patricia**ASAP**12Build working spreadsheet of committed vendorsJonoThis week13Reduce vendor layout to 60–70 spaces; number all booths on site mapJonoThis week14Confirm porta-potty booking — 7–8 units; confirm pricingYasmine**ASAP**15Contact Burlington Sound of Music organizers re: equipment lending (tents, barriers, tables)GregThis week16Confirm parking lot access with Bronte Legion for vendor parkingGregThis week17Finalize site map and submit to Town of Oakville for approvalGreg**ASAP**18Address Town of Oakville feedback on traffic control planGregPending town19Count apartment exits along race route; determine volunteer quantity needed for high-vis

coverageTeamThis week20Prepare resident notification letters re: road closures; organize hand
 delivery to building managersGreg2 weeks out from roads-close date21Determine if high-vis vests
 need to be purchased or can be borrowed (Moon in June, etc.)Greg Pace / GregASAP22Update poster
 design with QR code; print 50+ copiesGreg / PatriciaBy this Friday23Coordinate poster distribution — 5
 people, 10 posters each — this Saturday and SundayAll teamThis weekend24Submit media release
 with photo to: TV Halton, Inside Halton, Oakville News, Burlington NewsGreg / teamASAP25Approach
 Peach Coffee and Colombia Coffee re: poster placement + possible \$250 vendor/sponsorGregThis
 week26Reach out to Runner's Den re: influencer partnership / promotionGregThis week27Follow up
 with Lucas at Running Room (Charles's contact) for running community connectionsCharlesThis
 week28Design and launch social media giveaway (follow + tag mechanic)Greg / PatriciaThis
 week29Leverage existing sponsors' social media for cross-promotionPatriciaOngoing30Meeting with
 Kelly, Greg Pace, Charles to discuss interlocking three-race medal designGreg + Greg Pace +
 CharlesThis Sunday31Confirm Moon in June and Canada Day medal status before committing to
 interlocking designGreg PaceBefore Sunday meeting32Finalize t-shirt design direction; confirm
 cotton/poly blend and single-color (or 3-color) spec with BrentGreg6–8 weeks before race (by
 ~mid-April)33Finalize beer garden and kids zone layout; resolve stage proximity questionJono +
 GregBefore Town submission34Identify flat area for jumping castleJonoBefore Town
 submission35Confirm volunteer shirt/vest design and quantitiesGreg / Patricia6 weeks before
 race36Confirm Oakville Dads monthly coordination meeting scheduleGregThis week37Finalize band
 lineup for expo (2–3 bands, 10 AM–3 PM)Jono4 weeks38Confirm announcer contract and schedule
 (6:30 AM – 3 PM)GregASAP39Reach out to swim club re: vendor booth interestTeamThis
 week40Explore summer camps and youth programs as potential vendor participantsTeam4
 weeks41Schedule Zoom call in two weeks for progress updateGregBy March 6

*Minutes compiled from Lindy audio transcript, Apple iPhone audio transcript, and Lindy auto-generated
 action plan email (all dated March 4, 2026). Both audio transcripts attributed all speech to "Greg
 Kowalczyk" due to single-speaker AI detection; all attendees participated in the discussions captured
 above.*